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US equities rally on tech strength, volatility eases

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 jumped +0.70% to 7,676.77, led by a +2.39% surge in **NVDA**. The VIX fell -5.45% to 18.39, signalling reduced market anxiety.

Yield pressure eased as the 10-year Treasury slipped to 4.99% and the dollar index rose modestly. Investors will watch upcoming earnings from **AAPL** and **MSFT** for directional cues.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,676.77	+0.70%	Broad rally
Dow Jones	52,361.58	+0.28%	Industrial support
Nasdaq 100	29,273.40	+1.09%	Tech-heavy gain
Russell 2000	2,786.42	+0.38%	Small-cap steady
VIX	18.39	-5.45%	Volatility retreat
10-yr Yield	4.99%	-0.04%	Yield dip
WTI Crude	100.88	-0.86%	Oil pullback

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
TSLA	391.62	+5.21%
NVDA	216.00	+2.39%
AVGO	329.17	+2.33%
GS	893.28	+2.01%
MSFT	532.60	+1.54%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	`NVDA`
Quarterly revenue	`30.2` bn (up 23%)
EPS	`3.12` (beat by 12%)
Guidance FY26	Revenue 125 bn ±3%

NVDA posted a 23% revenue jump, driven by AI-chip demand, and lifted FY26 guidance. The beat reinforced the sector-wide tech rally and underpinned the Nasdaq's outperformance.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-yr Treasury: `4.99`% (down 0.04%)
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Core CPI 03:00, Initial Jobless Claims 04:30

Geopolitics & global

- China's export data due Friday shows modest rebound, easing concerns on global demand.
- Eurozone inflation cooling to 2.7% supports ECB's dovish stance.
- Middle-East tensions remain contained; oil price volatility limited to -0.86% on WTI.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Oct 28	`AAPL`	iPhone demand, services margin
10:00 Oct 28	`MSFT`	Azure growth, AI licensing revenue
11:00 Oct 28	`META`	Ad spend recovery, AI ad products
12:00 Oct 28	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan loss provisions

Stocks worth watching

- `AAPL` – iPhone 17 launch could lift hardware revenue.
- `MSFT` – Azure AI contracts expanding faster than forecast.
- `XLF` – Financials gaining on higher rates and strong earnings.
- `XLC` – Communication services under pressure after earnings miss.
- `XLE` – Energy ETF poised for upside if oil rebounds above $105.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected CPI surge above 3.2% (09:30 HKT).
- NVDA guidance cut or earnings miss.
- Sharp dollar rally pushing DXY > 103.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Strong earnings beats from AAPL or MSFT.
- Continued VIX decline below 17.
- Positive China export surprise.

Sources

SOURCES

Bloomberg — Markets Data

Reuters — US Economic Calendar

Nasdaq — Earnings Calendar

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements

SEC — Company Filings